



A picture password is easy to set up, but doesn't allow any more than three gestures

Microsoft Account

One of the things that might tick people off about Windows 8 is how necessary it is to have a Microsoft account in order to use it.

When you hear that all Modern UI Windows 8 apps need to be installed from the Store, it seems restrictive, but there is also the hidden implication, how do you identify yourself to the store?

The Windows store, since it is run by Microsoft, requires that you have a Microsoft account in order to use it. What this effectively means is that unless you have a Microsoft account, you simply cannot install any Modern UI applications on Windows 8, which means no applications at all on Windows RT since it only runs Store apps.

Windows does come pre-installed with a couple of applications, and these do not come from the store. However, even these applications need a Microsoft account if you want to use them in any meaningful way, or at all in the case of some applications.

The Messenger and Mail apps, for instance, both need you to associate a Microsoft account even if you want to only use them for non-Microsoft services.

Now, this isn't a big deal if you don't have a problem with having a Microsoft account. This is by no means something that is unheard of. Android devices need a Google account, while iOS devices need an Apple account. However if you don't like the idea of needing an account just to use a desktop OS, then you are a bit out of luck. Even Ubuntu needs an